

The Department of the Interior, United States Geological Survey, Water Mission Area, Observing Systems Division, Hydrologic Networks Branch has a requirement for a firm-fixed-price sole source contract to provide atmospheric deposition station operation services for a cooperatively supported station between the USGS, the site owner, and operator in support of the interagency National Atmospheric Deposition Program, National Trends Network (NADP-NTN).

Therefore, the USGS intends to make an award to Mr. Theodore (Ted) Smith unless the USGS is contacted by any vendor who believes they can meet the needs of this requirement. Vendors are invited to contact the Contracting Officer, Brian Baker via email at brian_baker@ios.doi.gov no later than 1:00 PM EST, Wednesday, April 1, 2026, with an affirmative answer.

The U.S. Geological Survey (USGS) considers employee signatures to be Personal Protected Information, and therefore all employee signatures have been redacted. By posting this document, the Contracting Officer attests all appropriate signatures have been obtained.

JUSTIFICATION FOR OTHER THAN FULL AND OPEN COMPETITION (FAR 13.1)

The following information is provided to demonstrate the proposed contractor's unique qualifications:

1. Operation of a NADP/NTN wet atmospheric monitoring station. Operation requires weekly site visits to the site to collect, process, and ship the precipitation sample. Also, to perform routine instrument checks, maintenance and repairs as needed.
2. The USGS does not have an office in the Alamosa area; therefore, USGS personnel are not available to collect samples. Mr. Smith has approval from the landowner and security clearance to service the site weekly which is in a public-restricted area of Alamosa Airport Authority. Mr. Smith is a former Assistant Professor of Aquaculture at Trinity Junior College in Alamosa, Colorado, and currently a senior aquaculture manager for the Colorado State Park and Wildlife Division and has extensive experience in monitoring atmospheric deposition measurement equipment and conducting laboratory chemical analyses of water samples. Mr. Smith's extensive experience and training in aquaculture at the teaching and management level uniquely qualifies him in the area of site CO00 to an equivalent level of water quality sampling expertise to that of a USGS scientist or technician.
3. Future requirements will be competed to the fullest extent possible.